



جامعة الملك عبد الله
للعلوم والتقنية
King Abdullah University of
Science and Technology

أكاديمية كاوست
KAUST ACADEMY



AI Summer School 2026

June 28 – August 20, 2026
King Khalid University (KKU)
KAUST Academy

Table of Contents

1. Introduction
2. Quick recap of your AI journey so far
3. Overview of what's coming this summer
4. Expected Learning outcomes



Welcome to **AI Summer School 2026!**

An intensive, hands-on journey into frontier AI research and practice.



2023



2024



2025

KAUST Academy: Mission + Who's behind it



***Prof. Sultan
Albarakati***

***Associate Vice
President, Saudi
Talent Development,
KAUST***



***Prof. Naeemullah
Khan***

***Deputy Director,
Instructional
Associate
Professor, KAUST***



***Mr. Abdulrahim
Alghamdi***

***KAUST Academy
Manager.
Literally HIM***



Ms. Oroba Al Nasr

***Promotions &
Outreach Manager,
Specializations Prog
rams Manager***

Meet your morning instructors



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Dr. Mohammed Ahmed
Week 1



Dr. Muhammad Mubashar
Week 2-3



Mr. Abdallah Hammad
Week 4-5



Dr. Ankuj Arora
Week 6



Prof. Tanveer Hussain
Week 7



Dr. Salman Khan
Week 8

Meet your afternoon instructors



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Prof. Amr Abdel-Hamid
Week 1



Poor Tas
Week 2



Dr. Ankuj Arora
Week 3



Dr. Muhammad Farooq
Week 4



Dr. Sara Durini
Week 5



Mr. Abdulhadi Zubailah
Week 6



Dr. Salah Abdeljabar
Week 7



Poor TAs
Week 8

Meet your TAs



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Ali Habibullah
The GOAT



Yazan Alshuaibi
Ali's Top 1% hater



Mohammad
Alshiekh



Mohamed
Eltayeb



Lama Ayash



Muhannad
Alhumaidi



Jana
Shata



Abdalla
Abdelrahman



Anas
Aldadi



Hussain
Alyafei



Hassan
Mohammed

Learning Journey Recap – Stage 2 (ML & DL)

Classic ML:

regression,
classification,
ensembles.

Optimization: SGD,
momentum, Adam;
regularization tactics.

Deep Learning

Basics: perceptron,
multilayer nets,
activations.

Tooling: hands-on
with scikit-learn &
PyTorch mini-labs.

Learning Journey Recap – Stage 3 (Computer Vision)

CNN & Transfer Learning:

convolutional layer,
residual learning,
EfficientNet.

Segmentation: Unet
& MaskRCNN

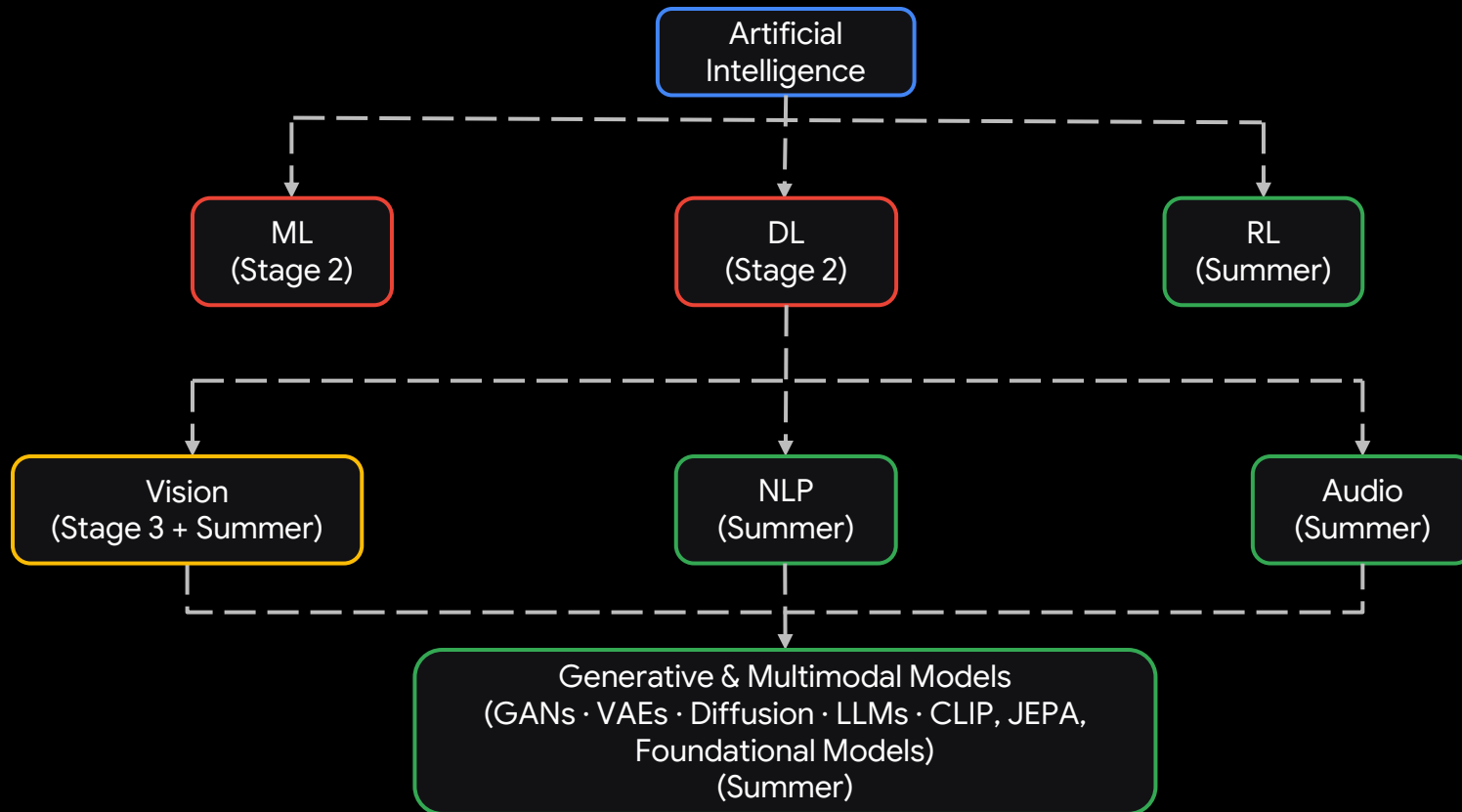
Practical Deep

Learning: data handling,
augmentation,
regularization.

Object Detection:

RCNN, FastRCNN,
FasterRCNN, YOLO

AI Landscape Overview



Summer Content



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Week	Topics	Instructor
1	CNNs, RNNs, Transformers, VIT, Videos	Dr. Mohammed Farouk Ahmed
2	SSL, CL, JEPA, World Models, Foundational Models	Dr. Muhammad Mubashar
3	AEs, VAEs, GANs, Diffusion, Stable Diffusion	Dr. Muhammad Mubashar
4	RL, Value Based, Stochastic Policy, Actor Critic	Mr. Abdallah Hammad
5	CC, Reward problems, RL in real world, RL Frontiers	Mr. Abdallah Hammad
6	Introduction to Natural Language Processing	Dr. Ankuj Arora
7	Transformers & LLMs, Reasoning, Quantization	Prof. Tanveer Hussain
8	Audio & Agents	Dr. Salman Khan

Afternoon Skills Track



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Week	Topics	Instructor
1	AI & IoT	Prof. Amr Abdel-Hamid
2	General Topics	TAs
3	MLOps	Dr. Ankuj Arora
4	Building Reliable Agents	Dr. Muhammad Farooq
5	Scientific Writing	Dr. Sara Durini
6	Game Development	Mr. Abdulhadi Zubailah
7	Communication & Visualization	Dr. Salah Abdeljabar
8	Project Work & Wrap-up	TAs

A Day at Summer School



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Time	Activity	Format
9:00 – 10:30 AM	Morning Lecture	Technical track
11:00 – 12:30 PM	Lab Session	Hands-on coding
12:30 – 2:00 PM	Lunch Break	—
2:00 – 3:30 PM	Afternoon Session	Skills track
3:30 – 5:00 PM	Project Work	Team project
Fri & Sat	Weekend Break	—



Expected Learning Outcomes

- Understand and evaluate recent AI research publications.
- Build diverse models across generative, vision, RL, and NLP domains.
- Implement and extend methods from research papers.
- Gain proficiency with advanced AI tools (e.g., PyTorch, Hugging Face).
- Apply MLOps practices to deploy, scale, and monitor models in production.
- Build reliable AI agents and retrieval-augmented (RAG) systems.
- Communicate and visualize results effectively for technical and general audiences.
- Collaborate effectively in teams on an AI project.
- Write and publish papers in top AI conferences.

Website



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